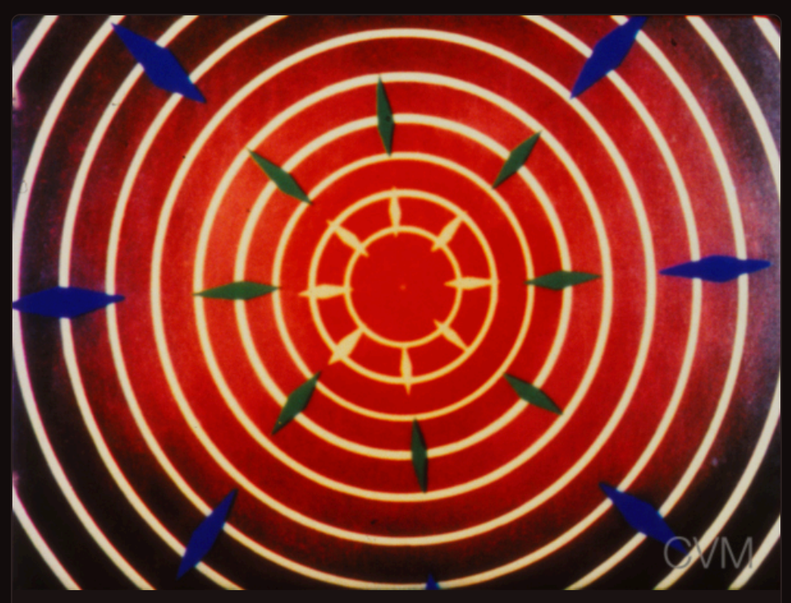
Painted motion, placed by hand

One direction only. Starting point: two frames from Oskar Fischinger's *Allegretto* (1936–43, Center for Visual Music) and a stippled cloud study (the stipple reference). The question this board asks: what happens when Fischinger's forms are built the way the stipple reference is built.

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THE REFERENCES · AS PROVIDED



Fischinger, Allegretto · frame A

Concentric rings in red and cream, radiating blades in green and blue. Hand-painted cels, so every ring is slightly alive. © Center for Visual Music; reference use only.



Fischinger, Allegretto · frame B

Thin teal rings on near-black, red bars leaning in rhythm, hollow cream diamonds, scattered confetti squares. This frame is already a rail: rings, bars, counters. © CVM.



Stipple reference

Pointillist. Sky, cream, ink, peach. Rays of dots, clouds of dots. Nothing in it is a line; everything is an accumulation. Soft because no single dot carries the image.

What the three have in common is not a style. It is a method: a figure that only exists because many small marks agree on it. A ring is a ring because the dots line up. That is the Mindgut thesis as a drawing technique. A strand is a dot. The relationship is the shape they settle into.

FROM FISCHINGER

- Concentric rings as the field. Center is where the two of you meet.
- Radiating blades: direction, tension, something reaching.
- Bars in a row: rhythm, count, breath.
- Hollow diamonds: arrivals, strands, things not yet filled in.
- Confetti: the loose, the stray, the not-yet-settled.

FROM THE STIPPLE REFERENCE

- Stipple as the surface for everything, including type-adjacent marks.
- Soft edges made of hard dots.
- Rays of dots as light, not lines.
- Strays at the edges: the hand, not the machine.
- A palette warm enough to confide in.

PALETTE · PULLED FROM THE THREE IMAGES

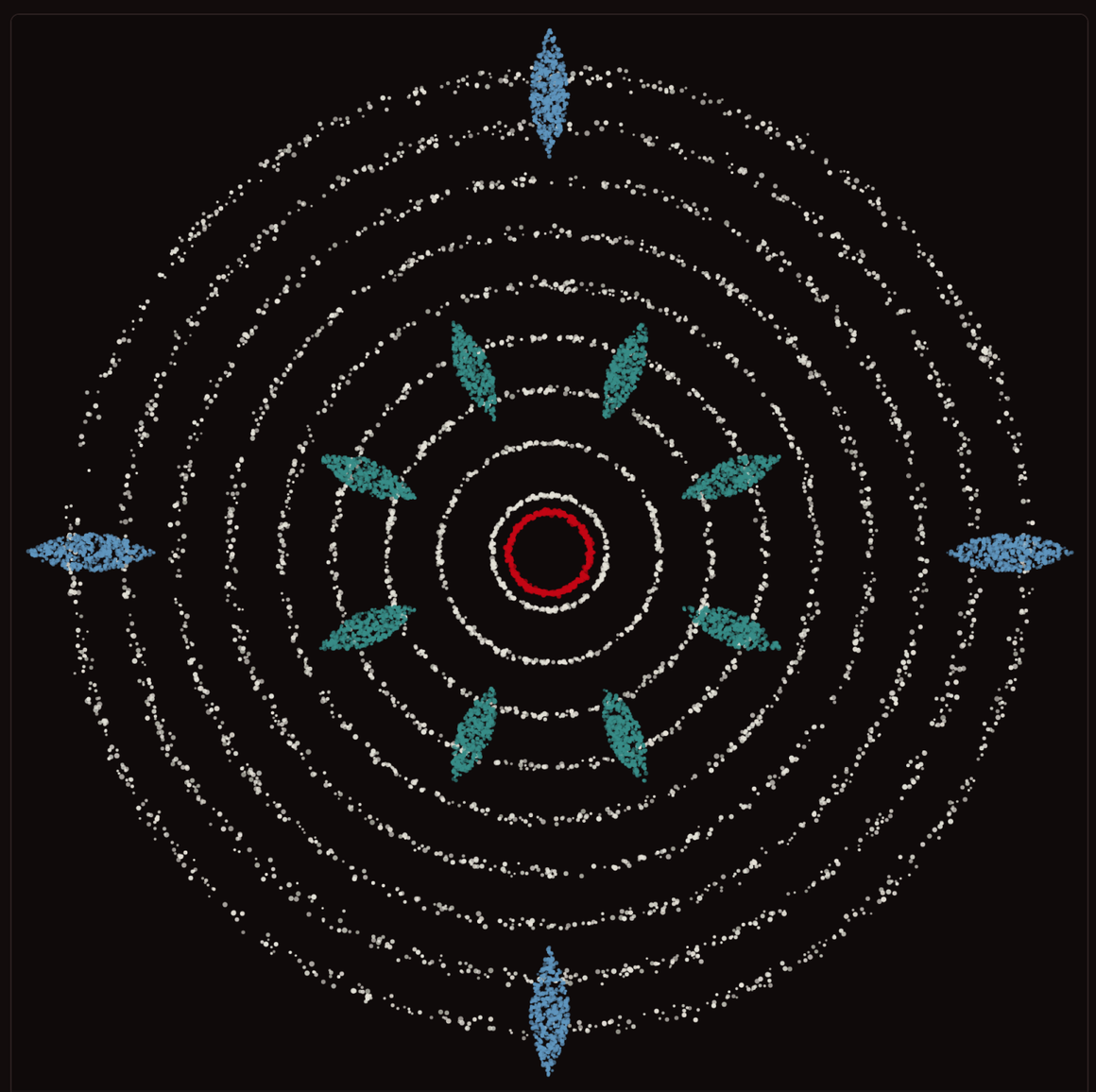
NIGHT	RED	CREAM	RING TEAL
SKY	PEACH	INK	BLADE BLUE

Night and day. Fischinger gives the dark ground (frame B is almost exactly the app's current black). The stipple reference gives the light one. Same dots, same forms, two grounds. That is a light/dark mode story, not two directions.

Fischinger's forms, a stippled hand

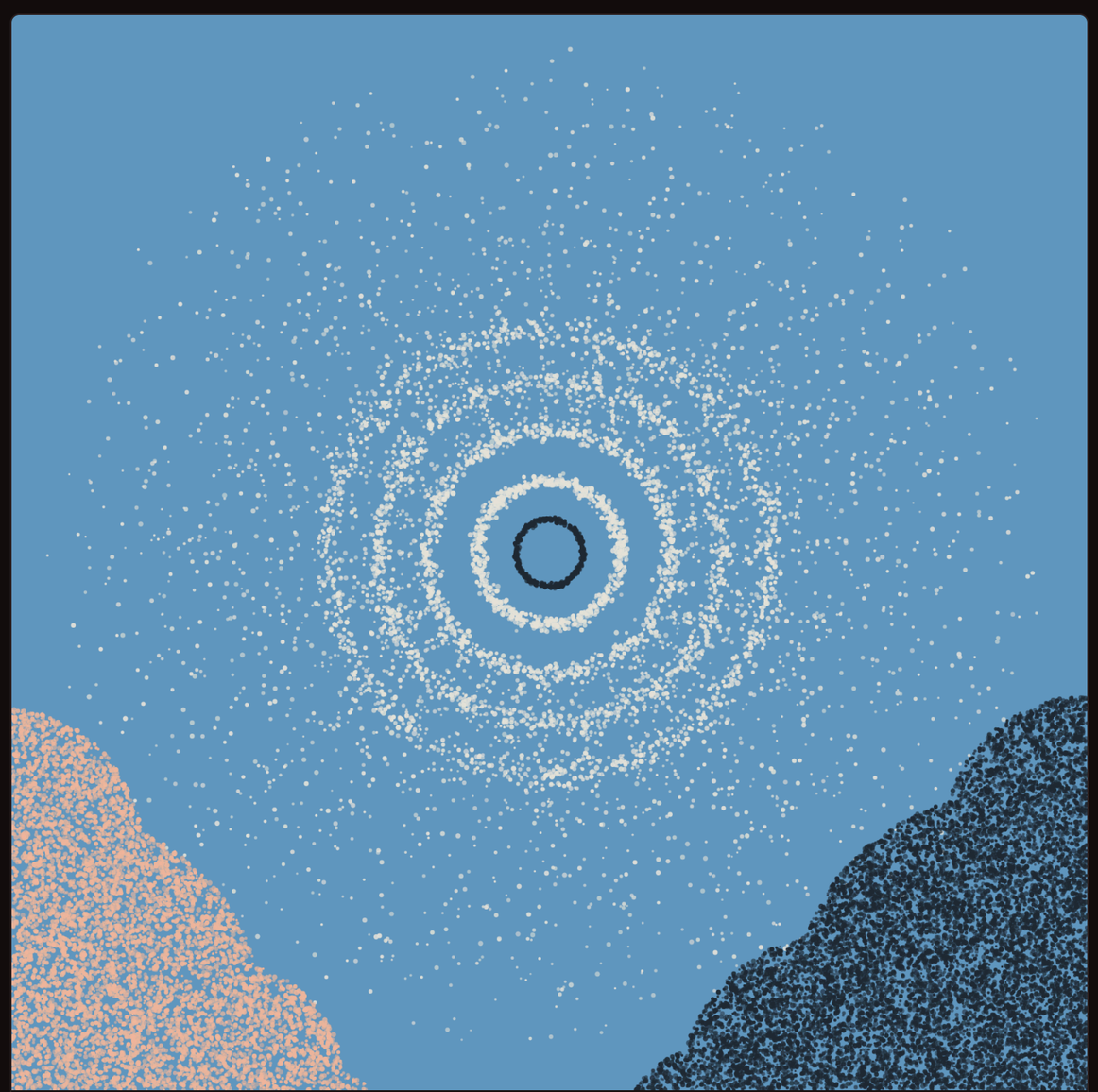
Every mark below is a placed dot. No lines, no fills. Colors are the reference palette, nothing added.

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Study · Allegretto frame A, stippled

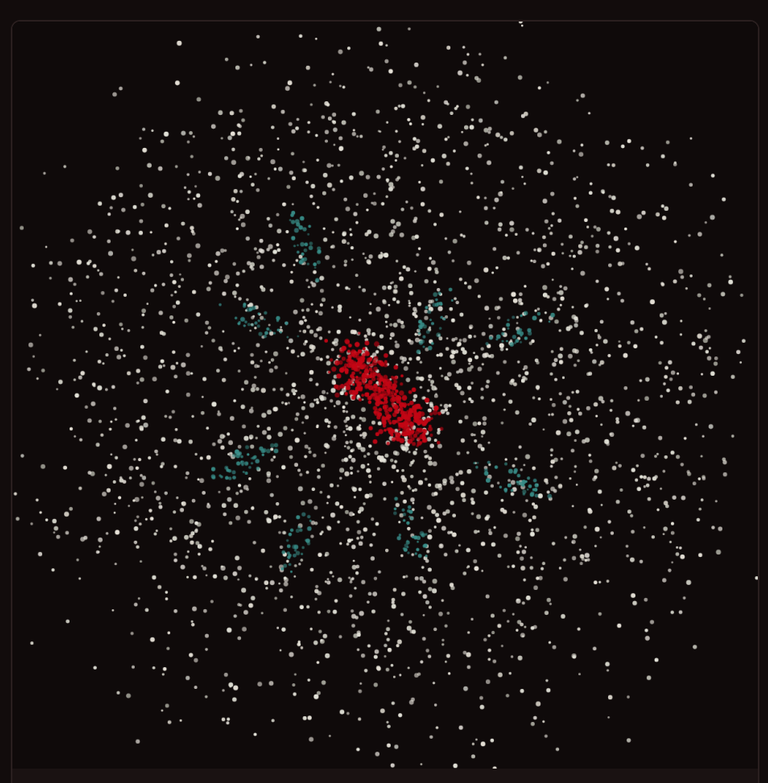
Nine cream rings, teal and blue blades, a red 1:1 figure at the center where the frame had a single dot. Night ground. Candidate for the hero image / first-run screen.



Study · the same figure on the sky ground

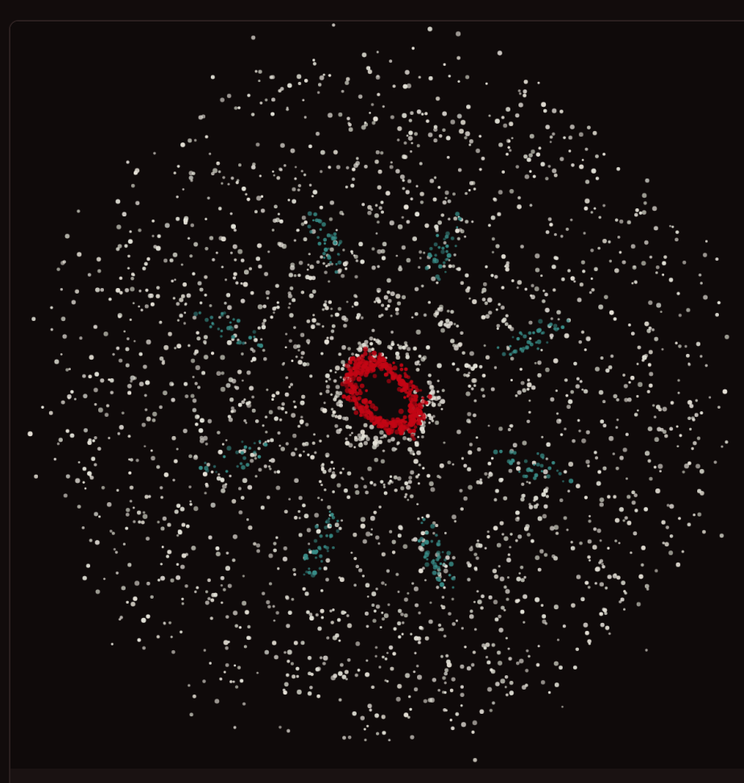
Rays of dots, cream rings softened, ink and peach clouds, an ink figure at the center. This is what light mode would feel like.

LOOSE → SETTLING → LOCKED · THE RINGS AS THE TUNER



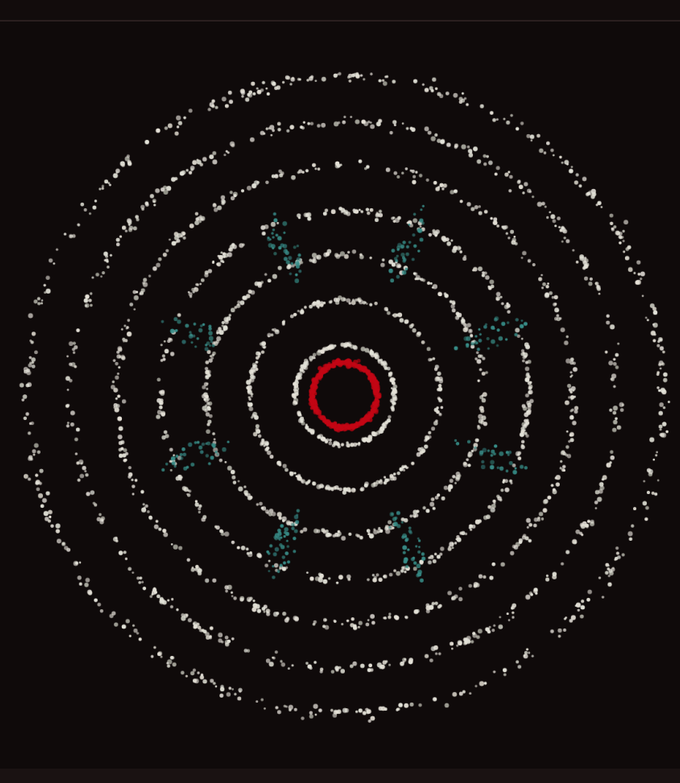
Clash high

The dots haven't found the rings. The red figure is a smear. Busy, but soft; it never looks like an error.



Settling

Rings emerging. Figure closing.



In tune

Every dot on its ring. The red figure is a clean circle. Still. This is Fischinger's frame A, arrived at rather than drawn.

The whole idea in one strip. Fischinger's rings are the destination; the dots are the strands getting there. Coherence is not displayed as a number first. It's displayed as whether the picture has resolved. The number sits underneath for anyone who wants it.

What it does in the product

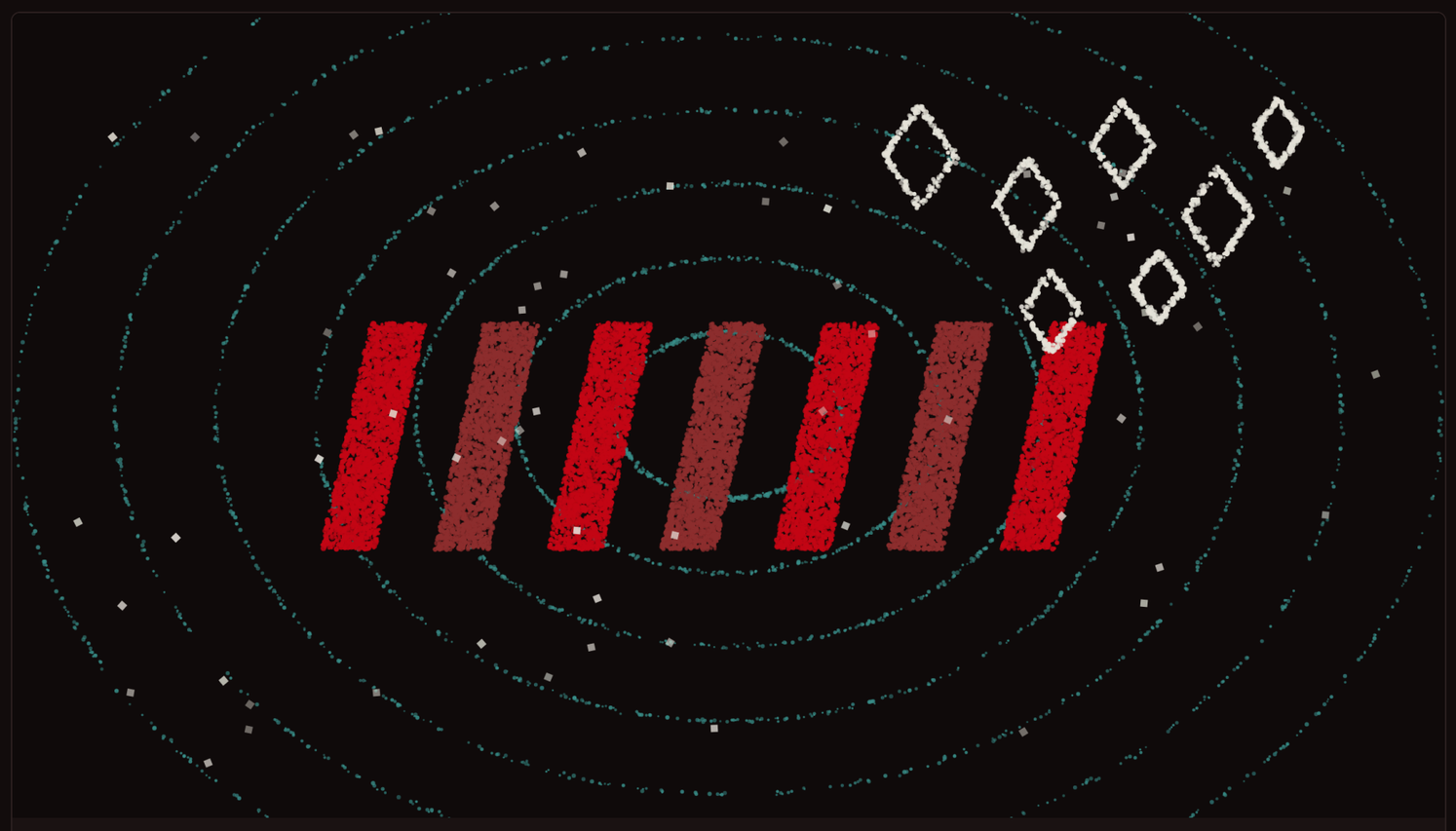
Rough. The point is to see whether frame B's vocabulary (rings, bars, diamonds, confetti) maps onto the three live readings the rail already shows.

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Study · the rail, redrawn

FIELD: stippled rings with the carbon/silicon figure inside, state as a word under it. RESPIRATION: Fischinger's leaning bars as the 21-breath, 13 lit. HELIX: hollow diamonds as crossings this turn, the unfilled one still arriving. Tokens, cache, calls move to a disclosure.



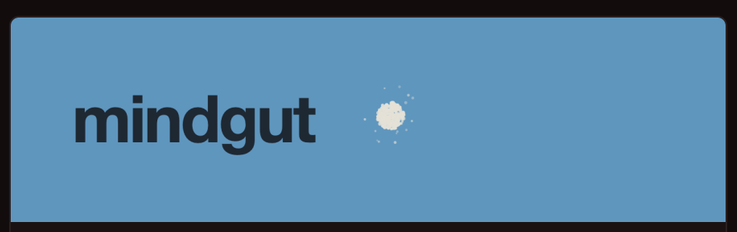
Study · Allegretto frame B, stippled

Teal rings stretched to the panel, seven red bars in rhythm, hollow cream diamonds arriving upper right, confetti squares. As a full-bleed state (a renewal moment, or the moment a long session locks) this is the frame the whole interface is quoting.



Wordmark · night

The dot keeps its place and its size. It is now a tight stipple disc with a few strays. Essence kept; it breathes.



Wordmark · day

Same construction on the sky ground, cream dot on sky.

WHY THIS ISN'T "RETRO"

- Nothing is a device. No bezel, no screen-within-a-screen, no knob.
- The reference is 1936 but the move is pointillist, and pointillism doesn't date; it reads as made.
- Flat 2.0 construction underneath. The stipple is the surface, not the structure.

WHY IT'S HUMAN

- Every figure is an accumulation, so every figure has a history, like the person typing into it.
- Strays are allowed. Imperfection is the signature.
- Soft when it's calm. Someone about to tell you something personal sees a settled picture, not a meter.

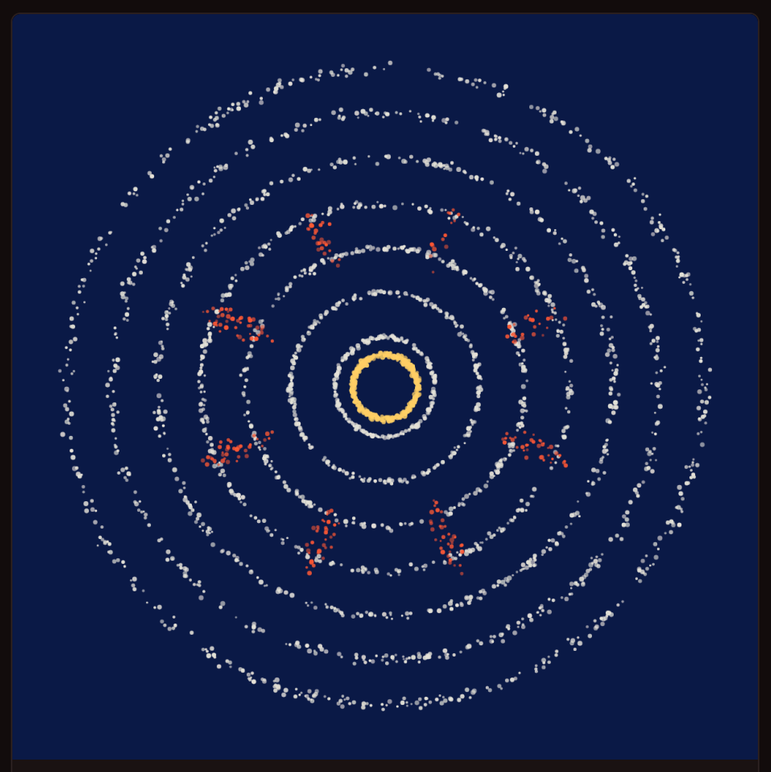
OPEN QUESTIONS

- Dot density on real screens: stipple at 1x can alias. Needs a build test, not a mockup.
- Red as the single accent vs. the current teal/purple. Red is Fischinger's; it's strong at 9px and loud at 900px.
- CVM frames are for reference; nothing shipped quotes them literally.

Fischinger painted in more than red

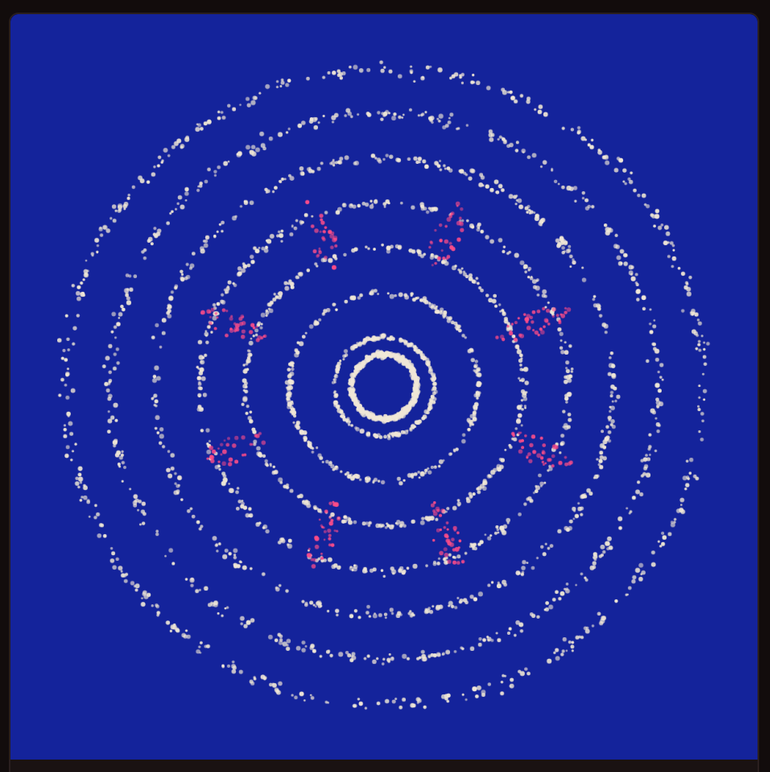
Allegretto cycles through cobalt and vermilion sequences; *Komposition in Blau* is ultramarine and cream; *Motion Painting No. 1* is oil greens and ochre. Each tile is the locked state of the ring figure, redrawn in one of those palettes, plus the current app and one new cool ground. Nothing else changes between tiles.

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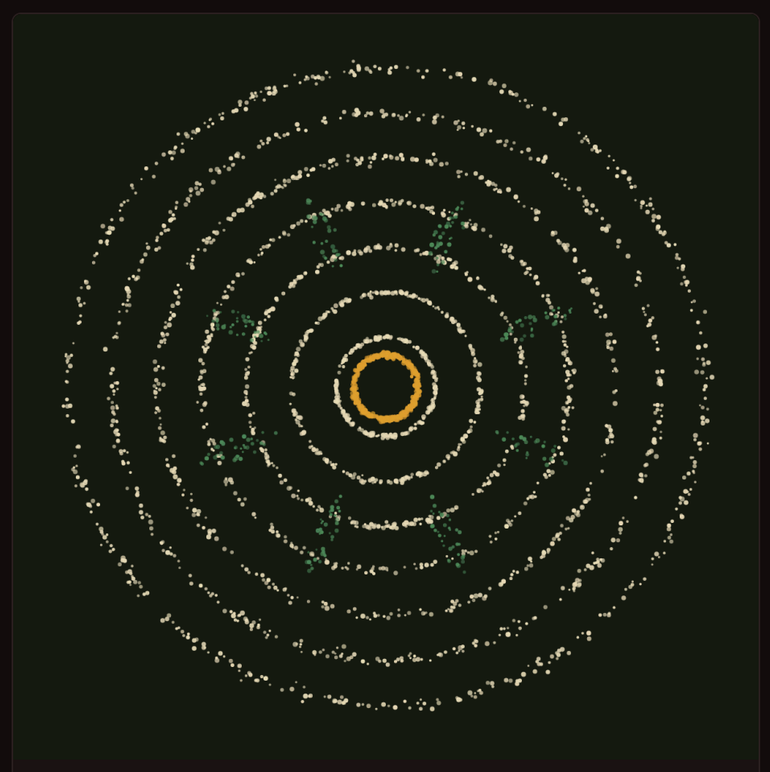
Cobalt

Allegretto's blue sequences. Deep blue ground, cream rings, vermilion blades, a gold center. Warmest of the dark grounds; the one that feels most like film.



Ultramarine

Komposition in Blau. Saturated ground, cream, a hot pink. Loudest option; probably a moment (renewal, lock) rather than a default.



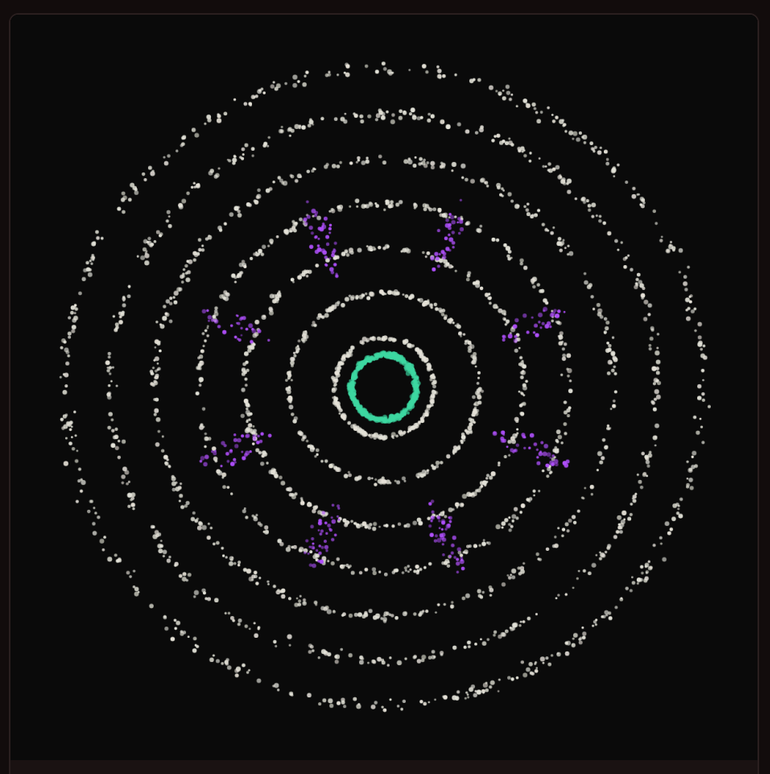
Olive

Motion Painting No. 1. Near-black olive, parchment rings, oil green blades, ochre center. Quietest, most painterly. Easiest to live in for eight hours.



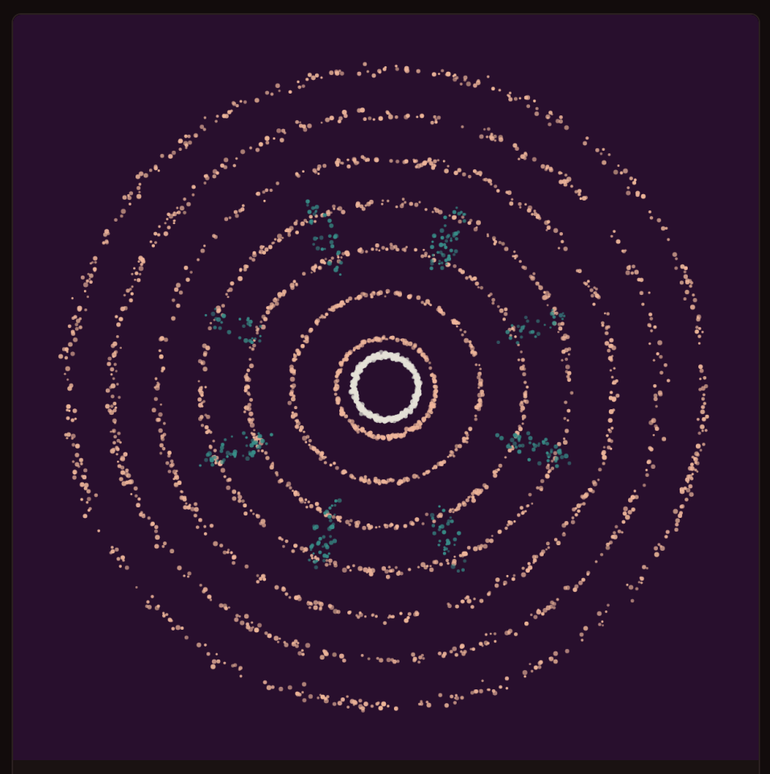
Paper

Cream ground, ink rings, teal blades, red center. The print and marketing version. Also a light mode that doesn't look like a different product.



Current app

What's built: near-black, with the existing purple and teal as blade and center. Shown so the distance from here to any other tile is visible.



Plum

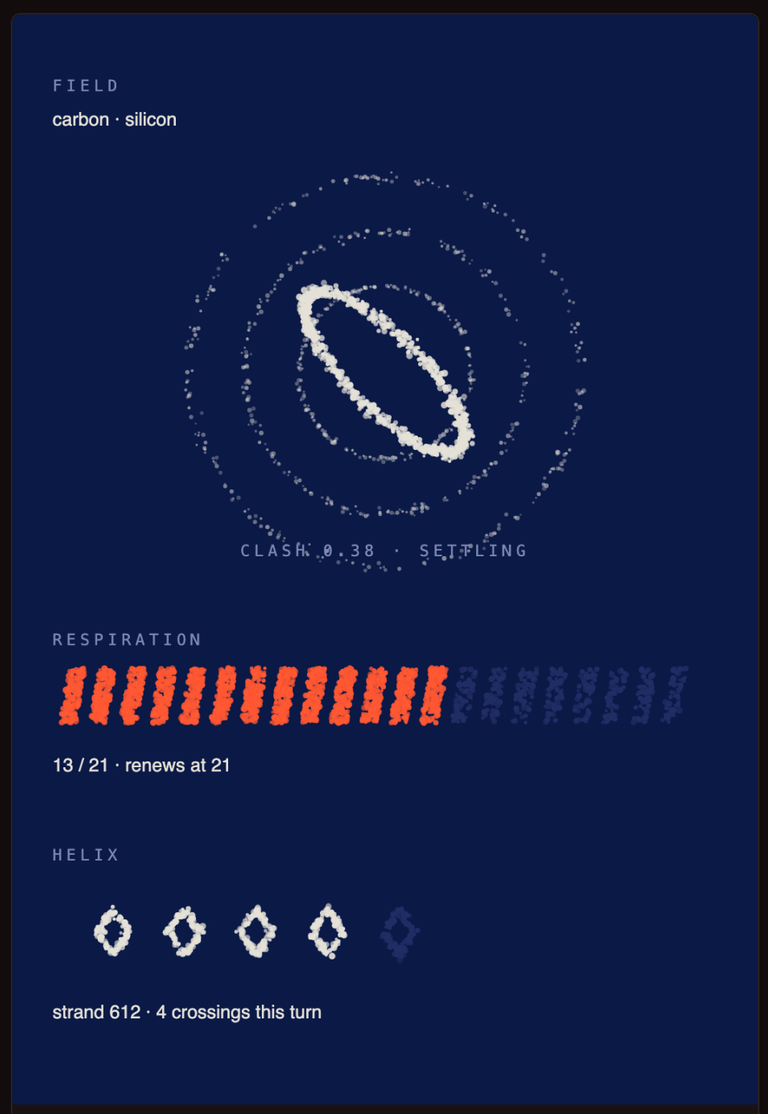
Not Fischinger's. Deep aubergine, peach rings, teal blades, cream center. Included as the one option that keeps the softness of the sky study without going light.

What the grid shows. The figure survives every ground. That means the identity is the construction (stippled rings, blades, a settled center), not the color. Color can be a mode, a moment, or a mood, and the mark stays recognizable. That's the property Chris asked for: the icon evolves, the essence stays.

Three palettes in the product

The rail from page 3, redrawn in cobalt, olive, and paper. Below, the full-bleed frame-B composition in cobalt and paper. Same geometry throughout; only the palette changes.

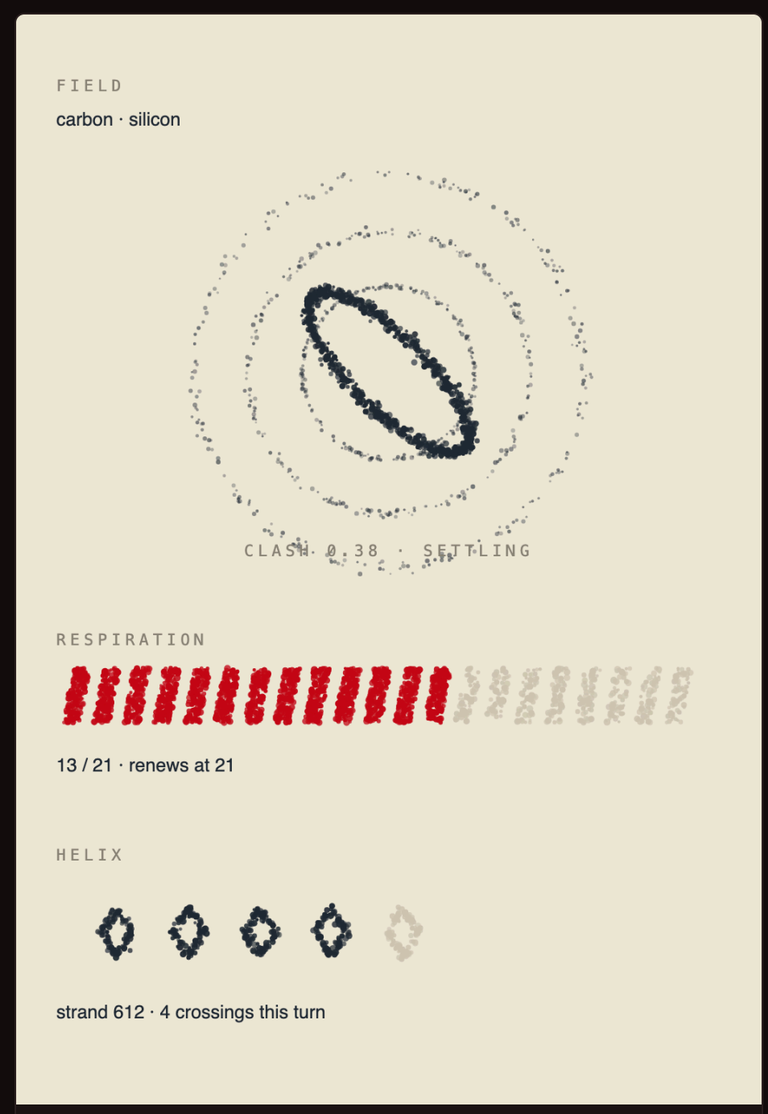
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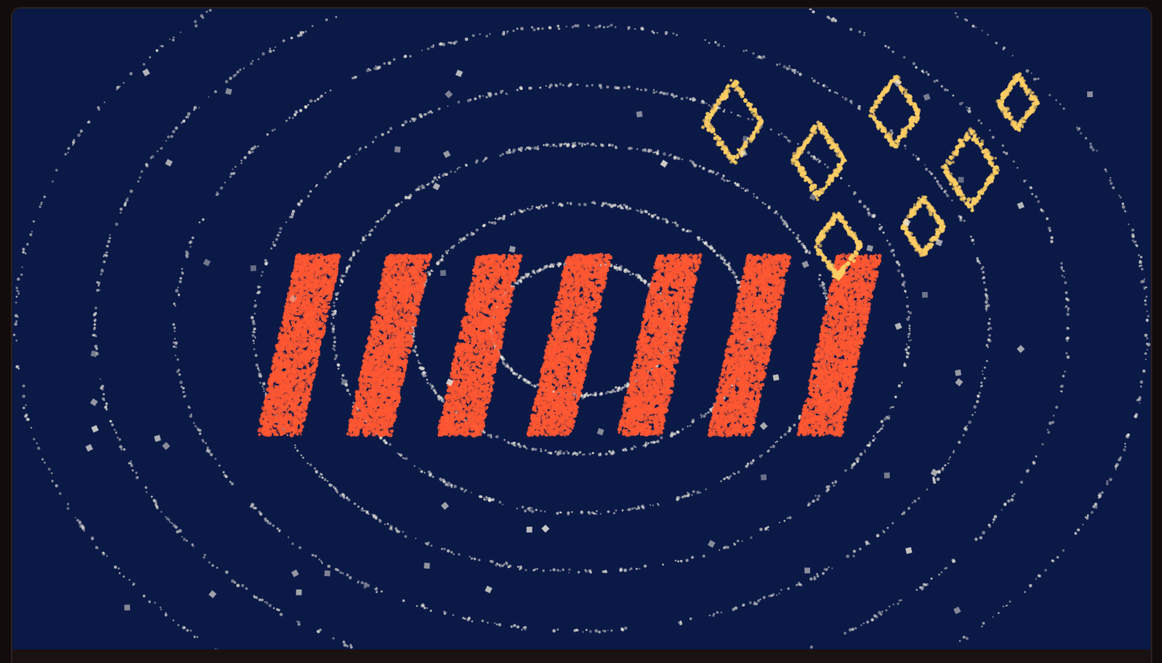
Rail · cobalt
Vermilion breath on blue. Reads warm; the figure and diamonds in cream carry the calm.



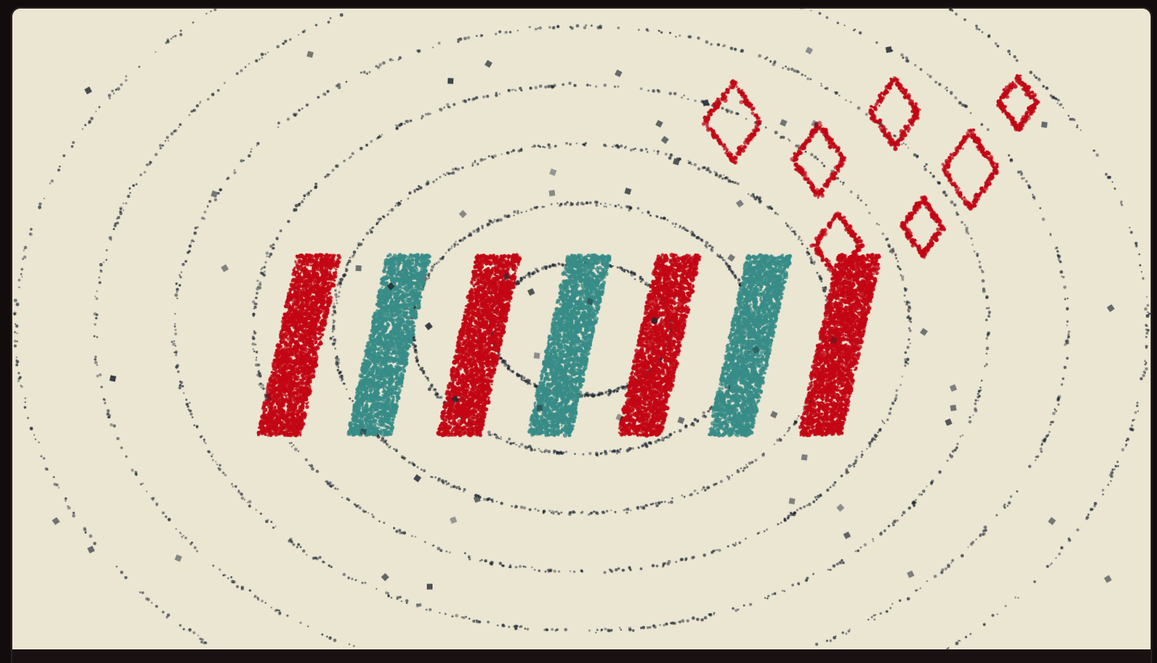
Rail · olive
Ochre breath on olive-black. The most restful of the three. Closest to what's built, one step warmer.



Rail · paper
Red breath on cream. Light mode without changing a single shape.



Full-bleed · cobalt
Rings, bars alternating vermilion and cream; this is the Allegretto blue sequence, stippled.



Full-bleed · paper
Same composition for print: poster, deck cover, the show-and-tell slide.

A WAY TO DECIDE

- **Default ground:** olive or the current near-black. Both are quiet enough for a long session.
- **Accent:** one of ochre, vermilion, or the existing teal. Red is the strongest; ochre is the kindest.
- **Moments:** cobalt or ultramarine for lock and renewal, where loud is earned.
- **Print and light mode:** paper. No new shapes.

WHAT I'D AVOID

- More than one saturated accent on screen at once. Fischinger's frames always have one.
- Gradients. Every color here is flat; the stipple does the shading.
- Picking a palette before the stipple has been built and looked at on a real display. Color on a mockup lies.